

SPEEDTEST

	Fast	Fast base	Base↑	Ind↑	Aus↑	Br↑	HK↑	SA↑	UK↑	USA↑	Base↓	Ind↓	Aus↓	Br↓	HK↓	SA↓	
CyberGhost	12	16	15.94	4.87	3.22	1.94	4.2	3.33	6.25	3.49	15.91	9.89	9.11	5.28	6.8	5.17	
ExpressVPN	15	16	15.94	15.78	2.07	6.26	13.09	4.01	11.21	4.73	15.91	14.87	2.42	6.32	13.69	5.37	
IPVanish	11	16	15.94	14.91	7.62	6.12	-	6.46	14.03	9.55	15.91	15.32	6.97	5.43	-	6.46	
NordVPN	3.3	16	15.94	15.3	7.66	5.79	8.6	6.89	4.83	7.71	15.91	15.23	7.49	6.45	13.41	6.65	
Private Internet Access	15	16	15.94	14.42	9.03	5.77	14.31	9.63	14.1	10.07	15.91	14.98	9.64	5.77	14.93	6.93	
PrivateVPN	15	16	15.94	11.76	13.5	5.87	5.62	6.82	14.23	9.79	15.91	15.07	14.84	5.57	12.4	6.46	
PureVPN	15	16	15.94	9.27	11.53	3.43	-	3.32	6.98	4.38	15.91	12.44	9.85	6.09	-	6.09	
StrongVPN	8	16	15.94	4.09	4.31	2.92	-	2.71	6.89	6.49	15.91	11.5	6.55	5.08	-	5.59	
Surfshark	1.2	16	15.94	13.26	5.89	3.44	7	4.37	6.56	4.77	15.91	14.87	12.77	5.75	15.01	7.07	
VyprVPN	2.5	16	15.94	12.4	8.7	12.7	10.1	-	7.65	6.47	15.91	13.2	15	13.6	14.5	-	

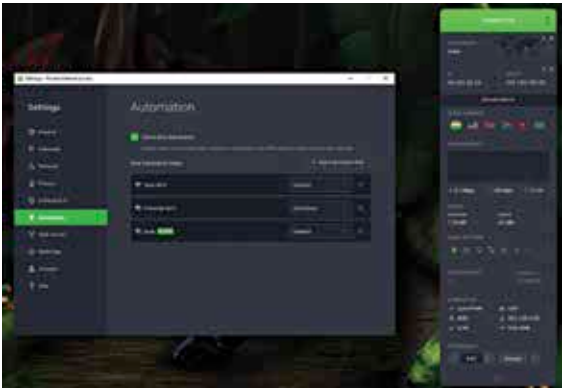
turned off! This feature is for those users who absolutely intend to use the internet anonymously, even if they have forgotten to connect to a VPN network. Private Internet Access also offers a “Mace” service that blocks traffic from domains that deliver ads, malware, or use trackers.

Private Internet Access issues a transparency report, supports static IP addresses as well as split tunneling. However, it is based in the USA, which is a part of the Five, Nine and Fourteen Eyes Alliances, and the service can be coerced by the US government to share personal user data. The transparency report shows 2 court orders, 12 subpoenas, and 3 warrants, with Private Internet Access responding to none of them with user logs. Private Internet Access is a subsidiary of Kape Technologies, which also owns Cyberghost, which is based in Romania. On September 16, 2021, ExpressVPN also announced that it is going to be joining

Kape, but clarified that it is going to operate as an independent brand. Kape has a fourth VPN service in its roster, ZenMate VPN which we have not shortlisted for this comparison.

Private Internet Access sensibly offers the best protocols on the relevant platforms. For example, the PC clients can only switch between OpenVPN and Wireguard. There are a ton of granular options for the power user to tweak the connection settings as per their own needs, geared towards faster speeds, or more reliable connections on patchy networks. Private Internet Access is one of those VPN services that can work on mobile phones accessing the internet through 2G connections in remote locations. As such, the lack of support for too many

alternative protocols should not be considered a negative here. The software also allows you to set up elaborate automation rules for when to establish a connection. For example, you can set



up the client to automatically connect when using a public Wi-Fi hotspot, and not use a VPN connection over a home network, where say the VPN is installed on the router itself. For those who like to tweak with the settings,

Private Internet Access is practically a fidget cube.

There are apps for all the major operating systems, with plugins for Chrome, Firefox and Opera, the only service in our shortlist to offer one. The payment options are limited, but users can avail the service through Bitcoin transactions. When it came to RAM usage, Private Internet Access was one of the most resource hungry services that we compared. The prices are on par with the industry average. Recently, Pri-

PRICE

	1 month	2 months	6 months	12 months	15 months	18 months	24 months	36 months	INR prices	Moneyback
CyberGhost	895	-	475	-	-	-	170	-	Yes	14-45 days
ExpressVPN	971	-	742	-	500	-	-	-	No	30 days
IPVanish	974	-	-	563	-	-	-	-	No	30 days
NordVPN	896	-	-	369	-	-	248	-	No	30 days
Private Internet Access	900	-	-	250	-	-	-	154	Yes	30 days
PrivateVPN	668	-	450	-	-	-	187	-	No	30 days
PureVPN	822	-	-	280	-	-	218	-	No	31 days
StrongVPN	824	-	-	500	-	-	-	-	No	30 days
Surfshark	899	-	-	249	-	-	186	-	Yes	30 days
VyprVPN	-	485	-	-	-	187	-	135	No	30 days